

STRICTLY CONFIDENTIAL

ASSESSMENT CENTER · FOR THE HIRING MANAGER

Hiring Decision Brief

Selection for Senior Manager, Corporate Banking

Noura Al-Otaibi

ASSESSMENT DETAIL

Organisation	Gulf Commercial Bank (sample)
Target role	Senior Manager, Corporate Banking
Assessment dates	12-13 May 2026
Assessors	Dr. Sarah Al Ameri (Lead), Mohammed Al Jaber, Layla Al Shamsi
Prepared	14 June 2026

Virginia Institute of Finance and Management · VIFM Assessment Center · Hiring Manager Brief

The decision in one view

3.1 Ready with Development

Noura is a strong analytical and delivery performer: she sets direction, isolates the assumption that matters, and turns ambiguity into a sequenced plan. The clear development priority is people-leadership - tightening how she communicates a recommendation and shifting from solving for her team to coaching them. Recommended as Ready with Development: appoint with targeted support on the two PEOPLE competencies. (Illustrative sample - synthetic candidate.)

OVERALL RATING

3.1

of 5

AT / ABOVE BAR

6

of 8 competencies

BELOW BAR

2

need development

CLEAR STRENGTHS

3

score 4-5

ROLE-FIT AT A GLANCE (BAR = COMPETENT, 3/5)

Forward Strategy Setting

THINKING · Strategic & Commercial Reasoning



4/5 · Strength

Critical Analysis

THINKING · Strategic & Commercial Reasoning



4/5 · Strength

Sound Judgement

THINKING · Strategic & Commercial Reasoning



3/5 · On Target

Outcome Ownership

RESULTS · Delivery & Execution



4/5 · Strength

Planning & Prioritisation

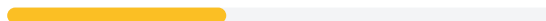
RESULTS · Delivery & Execution



3/5 · On Target

Clear & Adaptive Communication

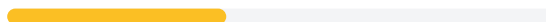
PEOPLE · Influence & Communication



2/5 · Minor Gap (1 level)

Coaching & Talent Growth

PEOPLE · Leading & Developing Others



2/5 · Minor Gap (1 level)

Resilience Under Pressure

SELF · Adaptability & Change



3/5 · On Target

WHAT THEY BRING

- + **Forward Strategy Setting (4/5).** Linked a tactical cost decision to the three-year portfolio ambition the panel had not yet surfaced.
- + **Critical Analysis (4/5).** Isolated the single assumption that broke the business case and re-ran the numbers before recommending.
- + **Outcome Ownership (4/5).** Took an ambiguous remit and returned a sequenced 90-day plan with named owners and checkpoints.

Validate the gaps, then onboard

The assessment is one structured input - not the decision. Below are the areas to weigh, probes to test them in your own interview or reference checks, and where to focus support in the first 90 days if you appoint.

WATCH-OUTS IF APPOINTED

- ! **Clear & Adaptive Communication (2/5).** Over-explained the rationale in the board brief; the core recommendation arrived late and landed diluted.
- ! **Coaching & Talent Growth (2/5).** In the direct-report role play, solved the problem for the report rather than developing their own thinking.

PROBE THESE BEFORE YOU DECIDE

- ? **Clear & Adaptive Communication.** Ask for a recent, concrete example that stretched this. Probe what they actually did, the trade-offs they weighed, and the result - and whether "Over-explained the rationale in the board brief; the core recommendation arrived late and landed diluted" still shows up under pressure.
- ? **Coaching & Talent Growth.** Ask for a recent, concrete example that stretched this. Probe what they actually did, the trade-offs they weighed, and the result - and whether "In the direct-report role play, solved the problem for the report rather than developing their own thinking" still shows up under pressure.

IF APPOINTED - FIRST 90 DAYS

- > **Clear & Adaptive Communication.** Lead with the recommendation then the why; rehearse a 90-second situation-recommendation-reason-ask pattern before each senior update.
- > **Coaching & Talent Growth.** Run one development-only conversation per direct report each month; replace solutions with questions.
- > **Planning & Prioritisation.** Add one explicit contingency to every plan and review dependencies weekly.

How to use this brief: the rating reflects behaviour observed across 4 exercises and the assessor wash-up consensus. It is a decision aid, not an automatic accept or reject - a single below-bar competency does not disqualify a candidate. Findings are most relevant for the next ~24 months. BARS scale: 1 = Significant Development Needed · 3 = Competent · 5 = Significant Strength.